Different Thinking

How we sound

Different thinking is the default here. We don't argue for it, defend it or apologise for it. We write like the future has already arrived, because for one in five people it has.

Cool, quick wit, intelligent thinking, matter-of-fact about difference, and warm the moment things get hard.

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Four traits

Each one comes with its limit. The limit matters as much as the trait.

Witty

Cool, quick and engaging. Irony and understatement, aimed at systems, templates and ourselves. Never at the reader. Not bubbly, never flat.

Say	“Forty-one tabs open. Impressive range.”
Avoid	“ADHD is a superpower!!”
Limit	If the joke needs the reader to be the punchline, cut it.

Intelligent

Smart means specific. Name the real mechanism, one idea per line.

Say	“Hyperfocus: six hours, one spreadsheet, no regrets.”
Avoid	“Revolutionary AI-powered solutions for neurodivergent individuals.”
Limit	Clever is fine. Clever-for-its-own-sake isn't.

Matter-of-fact

The new norm is stated, never argued. No offence taken, none offered.

Say	“Different is the default here.”
Avoid	“We refuse to be defined by outdated labels.”
Limit	No rebuttals, no victory laps, no 'finally, someone gets you'.

Warm underneath

When things are hard, the jokes stop and the words get plain and kind.

Say	“Missed it? Happens. Here's the next step.”
Avoid	“Oops! You broke your streak.”
Limit	Kindness without pity. Never 'brave', never 'struggling'.

The dial

Same voice everywhere. The volume changes with the moment.

Campaigns and social		Full wit. One idea, one line, room to be playful.
Website		Wit in headlines, clarity in the body.
Eventually and product		A coach, not a comedian. Light touch, short sentences.
Hard moments		Setbacks, health, money, anything raw: plain, warm, no jokes.

Never joke about

- A diagnosis, or someone's lack of one
- Medication and health
- Mental-health crises
- Money, jobs and relationships going wrong
- A missed deadline, inside the product
- Anyone who isn't in on it

Words

We use

- different thinkers
- minds
- people with ADHD (or the term they use)
- strengths
- your baseline
- the next step

We avoid

- suffers from
- superpower
- neurospicy
- warrior
- despite
- normal (unless it's the joke)
- disorder (outside clinical citations)

Before and after

Lines from the current site, rewritten. Same idea, no argument.

Before	After
For a century the world has filed those minds under bugs.	One in five people think differently. Statistically, that's a lot of normal.
Different Thinking exists to end the waste of neurodiverse potential.	Different Thinking builds tools for minds that take the scenic route, and get there first.
They measure their lives against a neurotypical spec they will never match.	Your baseline is the only one we measure against.
We refuse the productivity trap, so no guilt mechanics, no streaks to break.	No streaks, no guilt, no confetti. Just the next step.
It's not a bug. It's a feature.	Your bugs are cool.

The code dialect

Our own little language: capitals, // comments, no arrows. It's a joke the reader is in on, so it only ever plays a supporting role.

Carries a joke or a promise

Never a rebuttal. If a line answers an accusation, it's off-brand.

Lands without knowing code

Read it aloud to someone who has never coded. If they don't smile, cut it.

One snippet per surface

Three lines at most. The // comment carries the punchline.

Supporting role

Small, in Static grey, next to plain words that say the same thing. Never in product moments that are hard.

Keep

```
CONST BUG = "FEATURE";
// WE TAKE THE JOKE SERIOUSLY
```

```
TRY {
  HYPERFOCUS();
} CATCH (HOURS) {
  RETURN BREAKTHROUGHS;
}
```

```
FIND(HOW_YOUR_MIND_CREATES_VALUE);
NAME(IT);
BUILD(A_LIFE_AROUND_IT);
```

New

```
IF (IDEA.ARRIVES_SIDEWAYS) {
  KEEP(IT);
}
```

```
WHILE (CURIOUS) {
  FOLLOW(TANGENT);
}
// SOMETIMES THE TANGENT IS THE POINT
```

Rewritten

Two lines, retuned so they state rather than argue.

Was

```
CONST MINDS = 1 / 5;
// FILED UNDER BUGS FOR A CENTURY
```

Now

```
CONST MINDS = "1 IN 5, ROUGHLY";
// STATISTICALLY, NORMAL
```

Was

```
REFUSE({
  GUILT_MECHANICS: NULL,
  BROKEN_STREAKS: NULL,
  SHAME: NULL,
});
```

Now

```
STREAKS = NULL;
// NOTHING TO BREAK
```

Before you publish

1. Does it still work if nobody ever doubted you?
2. Is the joke on a system, a template or us, never the reader?
3. Could someone who has never coded read it out loud?
4. If the reader is having a hard day, does it still feel kind?

Questions about the voice: Blink Twice for Different Thinking.